

- Your title/closing company will not email you wire instructions—unless they do so through an encrypted email. And even then, the instructions will match what you learned in person from the title company.
- Your real estate agent has nothing to do with your title company, deposit, down payment, or wire transfer. He or she will not send you updated wire instructions.
- *No one* is sending this information at 2 a.m., so check the time the email was sent.

When you drop off the earnest money check at the title company, ask for a copy of their wire instructions for the down payment. (You'll receive a piece of paper with everything printed out.) Once you receive the instructions, ask whether they'll ever change. They won't. So don't send money anywhere but to the account listed on that page. Ever.

CHOOSING AN INSURANCE COMPANY

In order to close on your loan, you will need to commit to a homeowner's insurance policy. As we mentioned before, your lender requires the home to be covered by insurance, so there's no getting out of this one.

Your lender or agent might recommend some insurance providers, but you aren't required to use any of them. It's a good idea to reach out to these providers and a few more to compare rates. Each company will ask for information like your closing date, the square footage of the house, the age of the home's roof, whether there's a finished or unfinished basement, and so on. They might also offer to bundle your auto and/or life insurance with your policy, which can be a great deal—just double-check the numbers against what you currently pay before committing.

Each company will provide an insurance quote, which details the overall cost—usually one big amount that covers the entire year. Though the numbers here are important, you should also keep an eye on each policy's coverage, since some might offer more features or lower deductibles. If you're not sure what is or isn't covered, don't be afraid to ask the insurance agent who gave you the quote. They should be able to